

Oral Presentation Script

Fire & Phoenix - Chicago 1871

Authors: Abdulaziz Abdumajidov and Gülcihan Sağlı
Institution: Politecnico di Torino
Presentation Duration: 10-15 minutes

Introduction (1-2 minutes)

Good day! My name is Abdulaziz Abdumajidov, and today I, together with Gülcihan Sağlı, will present a project on the discipline "Digital Heritage".

The theme of our project: "From Barn to Legend: How Harper's Weekly Illustrations and the 'O'Leary Cow' Myth Shaped Collective Memory of the Great Chicago Fire of 1871".

The goal of the project is to show how digital tools can transform historical material into an interactive educational space.

Part 1: Project Description (2-3 minutes)

1.1 What we created

The project is a one-page multimedia website that tells about the Great Chicago Fire of 1871.

Features:

- Interactivity - user can interact with content
- Multilingualism - site supports 4 languages: Russian, English, Italian, and Turkish
- Historical accuracy - uses real Harper's Weekly materials from 1871 and maps of the burnt district from 1872

[Demonstrate website on screen]

Part 2: Technical Implementation (3-4 minutes)

2.1 Technologies

We used pure JavaScript without frameworks, which allowed:

- Full control over code
- Minimal file size
- Fast page loading

Technologies: HTML5 (3556 lines), CSS3 (~800 lines), JavaScript (~1200 lines), Canvas API for fire animations

[Show code examples if needed]

Part 3: Key Elements (3-4 minutes)

3.1 Interactive Slider

This is the interactive "Press vs Map" slider. The user can drag the handle and compare dramatic press illustrations with actual fire map data. This demonstrates how media transformed reality into myth.

[Demonstrate slider on screen]

3.2 Canvas Animations

We created three layers of animation: flames, sparks, and ash. This creates the atmosphere of fire and immerses the user in the historical era.

[Point to flames in background]

Part 4: Results (2-3 minutes)

Project statistics:

- 5556 lines of code
- 4 languages supported
- 10 main sections
- 30 quiz questions
- 3 canvas animations

The project successfully demonstrates how digital tools can transform historical material into an interactive educational space.

Questions and Answers

Q: Why Chicago Fire?

A: Perfect case for studying collective memory formation with rich visual material and known myth.

Q: Why no frameworks?

A: Pure JavaScript gives full control, lighter file, no dependencies, easier to understand.

Q: Historical accuracy?

A: Used primary sources: Harper's Weekly 1871, official map 1872, Chicago Historical Society materials.

Conclusion (1 minute)

Thank you for your attention! We are ready to answer questions.